



Real Easy Raglan



This raglan sweater is designed to be really easy, hence the name, and would be a great project for first-time garment knitters. With its relaxed and comfortable fit you will find yourself reaching for this sweater often, and its simplicity makes it a fantastic wardrobe staple.

The pattern includes detailed instructions with some handy extra tips for newbies. Starting at the neck, the sweater is knit top-down on circular needles, which is a great method to check the fit as you go, and is very easy to add or subtract length. There are also optional short-rows to shape the neck, but if you want to keep things super simple just leave them on out!

I hope you enjoy knitting your own Real Easy Raglan!

Emily



MATERIALS

- Sizes:** XS (**S**, SM, **M**, L, **XL**, XXL)
- To Fit Bust:** 74 (**80**, 86, **94**, 103, **110**, 118) cm / 29 (**31.5**, 34, **37**, 40, **43**, 46) inches
- Finished Bust:** 88 (**94**, 101, **109**, 116, **123**, 128) cm / 34.5 (**37**, 40, **43**, 46, **48**, 50) inches.
Designed to fit with between 6-15cm / 2-6" of positive ease depending on preferred fit.
Pictured here in size SM worn with about 8cm positive ease.
- Yarn:** Any 8ply / DK weight yarn.
We used Woolly 8ply (104m/50g), but a mix of 4ply yarn held with lace weight mohair would be divine, too!
- Quantity:** Approximately 748 (**857**, 972, **1103**, 1242, **1368**, 1501) metres
- Needle:** 3.50mm 40cm and 80-100cm, 4mm 80-100cm circular needles, plus same sizes in preferred needles for small circumference knitting (Magic Loop, DPN's, etc).
Adjust needle size as necessary to match pattern gauge.
- Gauge:** 20sts x 27rows to 10cm in stocking stitch on larger needles
- Extras:** 5 stitch markers (1 different one for beginning of round, 4 for increasing), scrap yarn for holding stitches, darning needle

PATTERN

Collar

Using smaller 40cm needles, cast on 92 (**96**, 100, **104**, 108, **110**, 114) sts and join to work in the round* making sure to not twist your stitches, and place marker for beginning of round at Center Back (CB).

*If you like, you can work the first few rows flat to make joining in the round easier.

R1: [k1, p1] repeat to end.

Repeat this row until ribbing measures 4cm from cast on edge, or desired length.

Yoke

Change to larger needles in 80-100cm circular length. You will have a bit of excess cable here,

but you can pull out a cable loop in between stitches to reduce the cable length, a la Magic Loop.

We will now place stitch markers for our raglan lines as follows:

Setup Round: k17 (**18**, 18, **19**, 20, **20**, 21) for half of back, place marker, k12 (**12**, 13, **13**, 14, **14**, 15) for left sleeve, pm, k34 (**36**, 37, **39**, 40, **41**, 42) for front, pm, k12 (**12**, 13, **13**, 14, **14**, 15) for right sleeve, pm, k17 (**18**, 19, **20**, 20, **21**, 21) for half of back, ending at CB marker.

One round worked. You should have 1 marker to indicate Center Back/beginning of round, and 4 markers for the raglan lines.



Short Rows (optional)

We will now work short rows to raise the back neck slightly for a better fit, but if you wish to omit them and have a simpler sweater without a defined front and back, then skip ahead to Raglan Increases.

R1 (left RS): [Knit to 2 sts before marker, kfb, k1, sm, kfb] twice, k3, turn. (4 sts increased)

R2 (left WS): Work 1 DS, purl to CB marker, do not turn.

R3 (right WS): [Purl to 2 sts before marker, pfb, p1, sm, pfb] twice, p3, turn. (4 sts increased)

R4 (right RS): Work 1 DS, knit to CB marker, do not turn.

R5 (left RS): [Knit to 2 sts before marker, kfb, k1, sm, kfb] twice, k to ds from previous row, knit the ds like a k2tog, k3, turn. (4 sts increased)

R6 (left WS): Work same as R2.

R7 (right WS): [Purl to 2 sts before marker, pfb, p1, sm, pfb] twice, p to ds from previous row, purl the ds like a p2tog, p3, turn. (4 sts increased)

R8 (right RS): Work same as R4.

Repeat rows R5 to R8 2 (**2**, 2, **3**, 3, **3**, 4) more times. You will now resume working in the round.

124 (**128**, 132, **144**, 148, **150**, 162) total stitches

Raglan Increases

R1: [Knit to 2 sts before marker, kfb, k1, sm, kfb] four times, knit to CB marker. (8 sts increased)

R2: Knit to end of round, slipping raglan markers.

Repeat these two rounds until you have 268 (**288**, 308, **328**, 340, **358**, 378) stitches.

[56 (**60**, 65, **69**, 72, **76**, 81) for each sleeve, 78 (**84**, 89, **95**, 98, **103**, 108) for both front and back]

Now you will increase on the body stitches only (sleeves are knit without increasing).

R1: [Knit to 2 sts before marker, kfb, k1, sm, knit to marker, sm, kfb] twice, knit to CB marker. (4 sts increased)

R2: Knit to end of round, slipping raglan markers.

Work these two rounds a total of 1 (**1**, 2, **3**, 5, **6**, 6) times, or until you have 272 (**292**, 316, **340**, 360, **382**, 402) stitches.

[56 (**60**, 65, **69**, 72, **76**, 81) for each sleeve, 80 (**86**, 93, **101**, 108, **115**, 120) for both front and back]

Next: Knit to end of round, slipping raglan markers.

Repeat this round until the yoke measures 20 (**22**, 24, **26**, 27, **28**, 30) cm, measured from cast on at center back.

Separate Body and Sleeves

We will now be separating our body and sleeve stitches. This is done by working across the body stitches of the next row, casting on new stitches at the underarm, and slipping our sleeve stitches onto scrap yarn using a darning needle. These sleeve stitches will be picked up and knitted later on.

Next: [Knit to marker, rm, slip next 56 (**60**, 65, **69**, 72, **76**, 81) sleeve stitches onto scrap yarn, using backwards loop method cast on 8 sts onto right needle, rm] twice, knit to end.

176 (188, 202, 218, 232, 246, 256) body stitches.

This is a great place to try your garment on to check the fit! Just slip roughly half of the body stitches onto a spare, long circular needle or piece of scrap yarn, and pop it over your head to see how it's going. Make sure to check again before casting off the body and when knitting the sleeves, it's a great chance to tailor the length to fit your own body!



Body

Next: Knit to end.

Repeat this round until the body measures 24 (**26**, 27, **29**, 32, **35**, 37) cm from armhole, or 6cm less than desired length.

Change to smaller needles.

Next: [k1, p1] repeat to end.

Repeat this row until ribbing measures 6cm, or desired length.

Bind off all stitches.

Our preferred bind off method for hems is a Decrease Bind Off like this one

<https://www.interweave.com/article/knitting/a-stretchier-bind-off/> But you can use whatever bind off you like most!

Sleeves

As the sleeves will be a small circumference* that is knit in the round, you will need to knit them with one of the following needle options: double pointed needles; short 23cm or 30cm circular needles; or with 80cm or longer circular needles and the Magic Loop technique. Everyone has different preferences for small circumference knitting, so have a play around and find out what works best for you!

*larger sizes might be able to begin their sleeves on a 40cm circular needle, which is nice and easy, but will need to switch to small circumference knitting when work becomes too small.



Setup: With 4mm needles in your preferred type for small circumference knitting, transfer 56 (**60**, 65, **69**, 72, **76**, 81) held sleeve stitches to needle.

Join yarn and knit across these stitches, then pick up and knit 2 sts in the gap between the right needle and the underarm cast on on the body, then pick up and knit 4 stitches along the underarm cast on. Place a new beginning-of-round marker on your needle, and pick up the remaining 4 stitches along the underarm cast on, plus an additional 2 stitches in the gap before the left needle. Join for working in the round and knit to beginning-of-round marker.
(12* stitches picked up)

*2 stitches picked up in the first corner, 8 stitches cast on to match the body, and 2 stitches from the 2nd corner. You have increased 12 stitches in total. The 4 total stitches picked up for the corners will be decreased in the following rounds.

R1: k3, ssk, k to 5sts before marker, k2tog, k to end.

R2: k to end.

Repeat R1 once more (4 sts decreased)

Sizes SM, M and XXL: k1, k2tog, k to end. (1 st decreased)

All sizes: knit one more round.

64 (**68**, 72, **76**, 80, **84**, 88) sleeve stitches.

Sleeve Decreases

Decrease: k1, k2tog, k to last 3 sts, ssk, k1. (2 sts decreased)

Knit 4 more plain rounds.

Continue working Decrease round every 5th round 7 (**7**, 7, **8**, 8, **9**, 9) more times, until 48 (**52**, 56, **58**, 62, **64**, 68) sts remain.

Knit without decreasing until sleeve measures 32 (**34**, 36, **38**, 40, **40**, 40) cm from underarm, or 6cm less than desired length

Cuff

We will now work one decrease round to reduce for the cuff. Instructions are written per garment size.

Size XS: [k4, k2tog] to end. (8 sts decreased)

Size S: [k5, k2tog, k4, k2tog] to end. (8 sts decreased)

Size SM: [k5, k2tog] to end. (8 sts decreased)

Size M: [k4, k2tog] 4 times, k3, k2tog, [k4, k2tog] 4 times, k3, k2tog. (10 sts decreased)

Size L: [k4, k2tog] 4 times, k5, k2tog, [k4, k2tog] 4 times, k5, k2tog. (10 sts decreased)

Size XL: [k6, k2tog] to end. (8 sts decreased)

Size XXL: [k4, k2tog, k4, k2tog, k3, k2tog] to end. (12 sts decreased)

40 (**44**, 48, **48**, 52, **56**, 56) sleeve stitches.

Change to smaller needles.

Next: [k1, p1] repeat to end.

Repeat this row until ribbing measures 6cm, or desired length.

Bind off all stitches and repeat for the second sleeve.

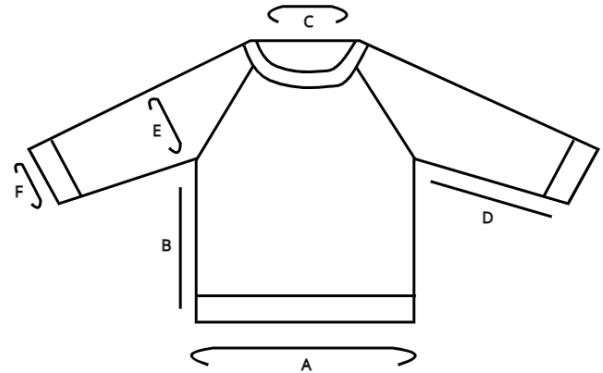
Now all you need to do is weave in any loose threads, and give your new sweater a good block! (Blocking is where you soak your knit in water, then dry it flat - easy peasy! You can check out our Blocking 101 post on our blog over [here](#))

ABBREVIATIONS

If there are any stitches or abbreviations that you are unsure of, just pop online and search for them! There are plenty of helpful videos and tutorials out there.

CB	center back
DS	double stitch (part of the German Short Row method, for which there are many handy videos online)
k	knit
kfb	knit front and back, a common increase
k2tog	knit two together, a common decrease
p	purl
pfb	purl front and back
pm	place a marker
ssk	slip slip knit, another common decrease
sts	stitches
R1	row 1
rm	remove marker
sm	slip marker across to right needle
[...]	Repeat section in brackets to end
... (...)	distinguishes measurements or instructions for different sizes

FINISHED MEASUREMENTS



A	Bust circumference 88 (94 , 101, 109 , 116, 123 , 128)cm
B	Body length from underarm 30 (32 , 33, 35 , 38, 41 , 43)cm
C	Neck circumference 46 (48 , 50, 52 , 54, 55 , 57)cm
D	Sleeve length from underarm 38 (40 , 42, 44 , 46, 46 , 46)cm
E	Upper arm circumference 32 (34 , 36.5, 38.5 , 40, 42 , 44)cm
F1	Lower arm circumference 24 (26 , 28, 29 , 31, 32 , 34)cm
F2	Cuff circumference 20 (22 , 24, 24 , 26, 28 , 28)cm

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<https://www.ravelry.com/patterns/sources/maker-maker-store/patterns>

Happy making!

